

Inquiry could upend hiring policy beyond Harvard

US investigates whether university discriminated against whites, Asians, men

By Aidan Ryan
GLOBE STAFF

The Trump administration has fixated on everything from college admissions to student discipline as part of its pressure campaign to remake Harvard University. But buried in the government's onslaught of demands and inquiries against the Cambridge institution is an investigation that could upend employment practices for institutions well beyond academia.

INSIDE THE WAR ON HARVARD

Harvard — which was on the losing end of the US Supreme Court decision that banned affirmative action in admissions — is now a key target in the conservative movement's efforts to roll back decades of hiring practices that encouraged an increase in representation of minority groups in the workforce. Specifically, Harvard faces an Equal Employment Opportunity Commission investigation over allegations that it discriminated against white, Asian, male, or heterosexual job applicants and employees. Regardless of whether the Trump administration is successful in extracting changes at Harvard — both are negotiating over a deal that would resolve several investigations of the university and

HARVARD, Page A7

A portentous trend: rising joblessness among Blacks

Specialists say data may signal weakening economy

By Katie Johnston
GLOBE STAFF

Workers of color are often the first to feel the impact of a weakening economy, and with the nationwide Black unemployment rate hitting a near four-year high, economists warn it could be a sign of more job losses to come.

In Massachusetts, the Black and Latino 12-month average unemployment rates have been rising since last fall, and while they have recovered slightly in recent months, at 6.8 percent in July, they are still the highest they've been in more than three years. Nationwide, Black unemployment has risen to 7.2 percent; the Latino rate has remained around 5 percent.

The white unemployment rate of 3.7 percent, both nationally and in Massachusetts, has held fairly steady for the past year.

As tariffs and mass deportations start to soften the economy, Black and Latino workers are vulnerable because they tend to have lower rates of

UNEMPLOYMENT, Page A10

A Cape Cod religious community faces a lawsuit that alleges it forced minors to work construction jobs without pay. **B1.**

Hamas accepted a new cease-fire proposal for Gaza submitted by Qatar and Egypt, but the Israeli government had yet to commit to the plan. **A3.**

Mayor Michelle Wu prepared to respond on Tuesday to the Trump administration's demand that Boston end policies the president considers friendly to undocumented immigrants. **B1.**

Air of superiority

Tuesday: Beautiful. High 69-74, low 57-62.
Wednesday: Sun and clouds. High 67-72, low 59-64.
Sunrise: 5:56. Sunset: 7:39.
Weather and comics, **D5-6.**
Obituaries, **C9.**

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WIN MCNAMEE/GETTY IMAGES

A remarkable array of European political and military leaders joined President Volodymyr Zelensky and President Trump for a White House meeting on creating a roadmap to peace in Ukraine.

Zelensky seeks security vows

Backed by EU leaders, he meets with Trump, who pushes quick peace deal



ANDRII MARIENKO/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Rescuers carried a body of a civilian killed in Russia's missile attack that hit a residential building in Kharkiv, Ukraine, Monday.

By Maggie Haberman and David E. Sanger

NEW YORK TIMES

Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky, backed by an extraordinary delegation of European leaders, defended his nation's interests at the White House on Monday as President Trump pressed for a quick peace agreement with Russia that would require Ukraine to make significant concessions.

Unlike the last Oval Office meeting between the American and Ukrainian presidents in February, when Trump and Vice President JD Vance berated Zelensky on live television, the meeting was outwardly cordial, with Trump warmly welcoming Zelensky to the West Wing after the Ukrainian arrived in a dark suit instead of his usual military clothing.

Zelensky arrived shortly after seven European leaders rushed to the White House to show support for Ukraine, amid concerns that Trump was more closely aligning with Russian President Vladimir Putin after Putin flew to Alaska for a meeting with Trump last week.

The Europeans — including Keir Starmer of Britain, Emmanuel Macron of France, Friedrich Merz of Germany, and Giorgia Meloni of Italy — have warned that if Putin is not stopped in Ukraine, he could ultimately try to take more European territory by force. Several of the Europeans called for a

UKRAINE, Page A4

Brazilian rap battle strikes a chord in community

By Marcela Rodrigues
GLOBE STAFF

CAMBRIDGE — As more than two dozen people circled around the first two rappers ready to battle in North Point Park, the group chanted in Portuguese, “Three, two, one, rhyme!”

With the Boston skyline behind him, Breno Pio stood on a paved path by the Charles River and faced Tyler Lopes. The Brazilian duo's eyes locked on each other as they rapped, ready to outdo one another with clever rhymes.

At 45-second turns, the two started with Lopes mocking Pio for wearing a São Paulo soccer jersey and Pio bragging about winning last week's battle. But as each verse progressed, the rhymes led to a more serious conversation. Pio said Lopes kept dreaming about him

since his win last week. Lopes countered: The dream was actually a nightmare.

“Você não é meu pesadelo. Meu pesadelo eu olho no espelho. Todo dia acordando, lutando com a depressão,” Pio said loudly, getting close to Lopes's face. His words translate to, “You're not my nightmare. My nightmare I see in the mirror. Every day waking up, fighting with depression.”

The minute Pio said the word “depression,” some audience members gasped and others nodded in understanding.

“I also fight [depression] when I'm alone in my room. Depression, you're not the only one who has it,” Lopes said, his voice rising in Portuguese as Pio shakes his head in opposition. “That's the terror. Stop thinking you're special,

RAP BATTLE, Page A10



JOSH REYNOLDS FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Tyler Lopes (left) and Breno Pio participated in a rap battle during the weekly Batalha de Boston event in Cambridge's North Point Park.

‘We have proven in Massachusetts that mail-in voting can be a safe and secure option for voters.’

WILLIAM GALVIN, *Mass. secretary of state*

Trump looks to eliminate voting by mail-in ballots

By Dylan Wells
WASHINGTON POST

President Trump, in a series of misleading statements on social media and public comments Monday, said he would work to get rid of mail-in ballots and sign an executive order “to help bring HONESTY to the 2026 Midterm Elections.”

►Newsmax will pay \$67 million to settle a lawsuit accusing it of defaming a voting equipment company. **A2.**

The comments are another sign that Trump is trying to alter the rules around voting ahead of the midterms. Trump has also instigated an effort to redraw voting maps in Texas to increase Republicans' chances of retaining power. It was not immediately clear what the executive order would entail, but any attempt to forbid mail-in ballots using executive authority would probably run into legal challenges, given that the Constitution gives states explicit control over election procedures.

“I am going to lead a movement to get rid of MAIL-IN BALLOTS, and also, while we're at it, Highly ‘Inaccurate,’ Very Expensive, and Seriously Controversial VOTING MACHINES,” he said in a post on his social media network, Truth Social.

Trump reiterated his comments during a meeting with Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky at the White House on Monday afternoon alongside European and NATO leaders.

“Mail-in ballots are corrupt. Mail-in ballots, you

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